Barsha Maharjan

Senior Product Designer

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EDUCATION

MFA in Design and Technology Parsons School of Design GPA 3.73 *2017 - 2019, New York, NY*

Relevant coursework: Machine Learning, Design for this Century, Narrative and Dynamic Systems, Virtual Reality, Creativity and Computation, Game Design as Play Design

— Dean's Merit Scholarship — University Scholarship

Bachelors in Information Management Tribhuvan University GPA 3.47 *2010 - 2014, Kathmandu, Nepal*

PUBLICATIONS

UX Reflex Theory: Lessons from Apple's Searchbar Experiment [Link to publicity]

Publication: UX Collective

MENTORSHIPS

AIGA NY Mentor *2025*

ADPList Mentor *2024 - Present*

Technology for Equity and Justice Fellowship Advisory group *2022 - Present*

MIT Reality Hack Mentor *2024*

All Women Virtual Hackathon Mentor *2022*

MEMBERSHIP

AIGA Professional member, *December 2024 - Present* [Link]

FIGMA PLUGINS I DEVELOPED

Accessibility Simulator Features: Vision simulator, Motor control analysis and Cognitive load analysis

AI Text and Lorem Ipsum Generator Features: Custom character count, Revert to original text

WCAG Color Contrast Checker Features: Color contrast analysis, Accessible color suggestion

PAST ARTISTIC ACHIEVEMENTS

White Shoes Drishyansha, A Nationwide Cell Phone Short Film Competition *2014*

Independent short film, Top 10 film selection, 650 entries globally

Organizer: Sarwanam Theatre and 360 Degree Mountain Films

Chagu Bakha

Independent short animation

Premiered on Dizzy TV *2022*

Premiered at We are here fest, Aborns Arts Center, New York *2019*

Puppetry UNDP Video Challenge to Promote Gender Equality *2015*

Team short movie, Official nomination

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer Candid.org *2020 - Present, New York, NY*

- Piloted the Generative AI project that transforms hard to read IRS's Form 990 texts into readable texts with 89.74% profile manager adoption rate enhancing how nonprofits communicate their story and impact. [Link]
- Led the redesign of GuideStar and Foundation Directory's features on the new Candid Platform, enabling nonprofits and grantmakers nationwide to effectively showcase and search for the organization's value, impact and story.
- As a design and development lead, successfully launched the revamped Philanthropy News Digest (450,000 page views per month).
- Led the design of Candid Data System, the organization's centralized enterprise database system. Identified problem areas from user interviews, which were then modified for optimal performance by refining the user interface and user flow resulting in improved performance metrics.
- Conducted and analyzed UX interviews through moderated and unmoderated user tests, collaborating closely with UX researchers to validate product development and ensure user adoption and satisfaction.
- Strategic alignment with engineers and product managers on engineering scope, ensuring efficient delivery of immediate quarterly objectives while maintaining long-term technical vision.
- Design QA to make sure the work delivered are up to the design and development standard.
- Built a design system pattern library from scratch for the design team for quicker prototyping and monitor new additions. Oversee, document and maintain the design system library.
- Conducted and analyzed UX interviews through moderated and unmoderated user tests, collaborating closely with UX researchers to validate product development and ensure user adoption and satisfaction.

UX/UI Designer and Developer COREWEAVE *2019, New Jersey*

- Designed and developed the revamp of Concierge Render, a 3D rendering platform.
- Created graphics for social media presence and introduced visual design to demonstrate how the company empowers the creators.

UX Research Fellow VERIZON 5G, NYC MEDIA LAB, YAHOO SPORTS *2018, New York, NY*

- Received $5000 grant for design research on customer discovery and market validation of 5G technology in sports. Conducted 80+ in-person interviews through an 8-week Lean Launchpad training.
- Built a start-up and successfully pitched the demo to investors. [Media link]

Teaching and Research Assiatant PARSONS SCHOOL OF DESIGN *2019, New York, NY*

- Taught a bootcamp course to incoming graduate students in the Design and Technology program. The course covered front-end development, digital product design, and design thinking and principles.
- As a TA, collaborated with Tongji University in China for an interactive digital media course, Motion Capture at a Distance.

UX/UI Designer and Developer FUSEMACHINES *2014 - 2017, Nepal*

- Led end-to-end website development projects by creating design templates and rapid prototypes while maintaining brand consistency and guidelines.
- Managed client relationships across tech and education sectors, establishing project scopes, interaction guidelines, and timelines to ensure successful delivery.

SKILLS

Strategic	Design	Tech and tools	Research
Product vision	Complex interface design	HTML/CSS	Data driven decision
Business strategy	Design system	Figma	Competitive analysis
Product roadmap	Pattern library	Lucid chart	User research & interview
Impact metric	Prototype / wireframe	Jira	User journey map
Cross-team collaboration	Version control	Kendis	Usability test
Team leadership	Responsive design	Hotjar	
Design mentorship	Documentation		